

Why?

Lava Lamp is a student magazine at the American University in Bulgaria. It relies on collaborative work and trust. Our reputation and quality depend entirely on our contributors' individual responsibility. We expect transparency and integrity to be leading principles of your work in Lava Lamp.

Plagiarism & AI

Plagiarism and fabrication of any kind is strictly prohibited. This includes, but is not limited to, deliberately using someone else's ideas or work as your own without giving the proper credit. For more information on plagiarism and fabrication, please visit <https://uark.pressbooks.pub/journalismethics/chapter/chapter-8/>.

Similarly, any use of AI-generated materials will be considered plagiarism. Lava Lamp is an AI-free zone, so no trace of AI should be found in your finished piece.

Reporting with Dignity

All reporting featured in the magazine should be original and adhere to the highest ethical standards of journalism. Here are some things to consider:

- **Accuracy and Fairness:** Our reporting should present accurate and verified information while also including a diverse set of voices and opinions.
- **Independence:** Avoid conflicts of interest and ensure independence of sources.
- **Acquisition and Presentation of Information:** Gather information by fair and legal means, respecting the human rights described under the EU Charter of Fundamental Rights. Sources must be identified.

For more information, visit

<https://www.spj.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/Code-Of-Ethics-Bookmark.pdf>.

Our role as journalists and storytellers is to serve the public interest, even if that means one less colorful detail or one more day's worth of work.

Corrections Policy

We shall publish a clear and appropriately prominent correction when a factual mistake has been published, and provide an apology if necessary. We encourage our readers to contact us if they spot such a mistake.

Editing Process

All edits will be discussed with the author before publishing his/her story.

Sources Consulted:

<https://aej-bulgaria.org/en/ethical-code-of-the-bulgarian-media/>
<https://www.nytimes.com/article/new-york-times-corrections.html>